

VIKRAM SHARMA

"Practise traffic control of the mind"

By **SISTER B.K. SHIVANI**

HAPPINESS MANTRA

"Do not accept an unhappy state of mind as normal. Jealousy, anger are not normal, love, peace are"

Happiness is a state of mind. But today we believe happiness is what we achieve or what we buy, that it is dependent on external situations and achievements. The truth is, happiness is our nature, our way of being. When the mind is calm and stable, it is in a healthy state and that health of the mind is happiness.

Being in that healthy state of mind is in our hands. For instance, if I am stuck in a traffic jam, I can choose to create stress or be stable. When things do not go my way, I can choose to get hurt or remain healthy. Happiness is a healthy mind; when the mind is in a comfortable state, it is the opposite of a disturbed mind.

For me, it matters how my state of mind is in every situation of the day. Let me explain why. When my mind's graph does not fluctuate, then I have been happy throughout the day. By fluctuation, I mean getting excited one moment, feeling low the next.

To be truly happy, it is important that you stop living a life of blame. By this, I mean blaming people and situations for your own condition. Blame games show emotional dependence. Creating your own thoughts, feelings and steering clear of any dependency will lead to a happy life.

I now live a life of awareness, so when making a mistake, even if it is in my mind only, I immediately correct it. My advice—practise traffic control of the mind. Pause for a minute after every hour and check your thoughts, it helps to prepare the mind for the next hour.

One of the biggest problems today is that people have accepted an unhappy state of mind as normal. Do not do that. Jealousy, anger, worry and stress are not normal, while love, happiness and peace are. It's time to change your definition of normal. For once you know what is normal, you will automatically (consciously or subconsciously) start doing things towards achieving it. ■

***Sr Shivani is a well-known teacher of Rajyoga meditation and host of the popular TV show* Awakening with Brahma Kumaris**